

PANKAJ TIWARI

A FALL INTO INFAMY

The fall of **Asaram Bapu** shattered the aura of invincibility around self-styled godmen. His conviction exposed how reverence, authority and silence enabled abuse, marking a turning point in public willingness to question and confront powerful spiritual figures.



GETTY IMAGES

YOGA GOES GLOBAL

India's push for **International Yoga Day** reflected a new confidence in cultural diplomacy. Yoga was projected as civilisational soft power, blending wellness with global outreach. The move enhanced India's global visibility while also triggering debates on identity and appropriation at home.

National Murder Mysteries

The **Aarushi Talwar** case exposed deep failures in policing, forensics and media ethics. Conflicting investigations and sensational coverage turned a murder into a prolonged public spectacle. The case became a cautionary tale of how class bias and incompetence can derail justice.





The **Nithari killings** revealed the invisibility of the poor within India's urban children went unnoticed until horror forced attention. The case exposed systemic apathy and the unequal value placed on lives.



FAWZAN HUSAIN



BHASKAR PAUL

AVIATION BOOM AND DOOM

India's aviation boom opened with a quiet disruption when IndiGo launched as a no-frills carrier in 2006, rewriting the rules of affordability and efficiency in the skies. What followed was spectacular ambition and equally spectacular collapse. Vijay Mallya (above) became a symbol of excess and impunity, while Naresh Goyal's Jet Airways reflected disciplined growth ultimately undone by structural strain, together capturing liberalisation's promise and peril in Indian aviation.